

10과 아버지는 요리를 잘하세요

Chapter 10 — My father cooks well

This chapter at a glance

주제	Topic 가족 — family
어휘와 문법	Vocabulary & grammar 가족 관계, 높임말 / 동형-으시- / 동형-지만 — family relations and honorific words · the honorific infix · "but"
활동	Activities 가족 소개하기, 가족 소개 글 읽고 쓰기 — introducing your family; reading and writing about it
문화와 정보	Culture & information 가족 호칭 — what Koreans call their relatives

This chapter is where Korean's honorific system arrives properly. Until now politeness lived in the ending — 해요 versus 합니다. Here it moves inside the verb: 하세요 raises the person you are talking *about*, not the person you are talking *to*. That is a distinction English simply does not have, and it takes a while to feel.

The chapter title shows it working. 아버지는 요리를 잘하세요 — my father cooks well — has 시 in it even though the speaker is talking to a friend, not to their father. In Korean you honour your own parents when describing them to anyone.

도입

Warm-up

가족들이 지금 뭐 해요?

What are the families doing right now?

여러분 가족은 지금 어디에서 뭐 해요?

Where is your family right now, and what are they doing?

The page shows three family scenes: an elderly couple sharing cake and coffee in a café; a grandmother reading with her granddaughter at a table; and two men in aprons cooking together, one tasting from a spoon while the other chops. All three are family members doing ordinary things — which is exactly what you will be describing, in honorific form, by the end of the chapter.

Both questions are still in plain 해요 form. Watch what happens on page 115: the same question becomes 뭐 하세요? The book is setting up the contrast before it teaches it, exactly as chapter 9 did with the past tense.

가족들 carries the plural 들 here because the page really does mean several separate families. Compare 우리 가족, which is one family treated as a unit and never takes 들.

어휘와 문법 1

Vocabulary & grammar 1

가족 호칭을 알아요? 이야기해 보세요.

Do you know the words for family members? Talk about them.

The page is a family tree. The top row is the four grandparents, the middle row the parents, and the bottom two rows the siblings — drawn twice, because what you call an older brother or sister depends on whether you are male or female.

조부모 — Grandparents

할아버지

grandfather, father's side

할머니

grandmother, father's side

외할아버지

grandfather, mother's side

외할머니

grandmother, mother's side

부모 — Parents

아버지 (아빠)

father (dad)

어머니 (엄마)

mother (mum)

나(여자) — if you are female

언니

older sister

오빠

older brother

나(남자) — if you are male

누나

older sister

형

older brother

동생 — Younger siblings, whoever you are

남동생

younger brother

여동생

younger sister

This is the hardest thing on the page, so take it slowly: the word for an older sibling depends on the *speaker's* gender, not the sibling's. A woman says 언니 and 오빠; a man says 누나 and 형. The same person can be someone's 언니 and someone else's 누나 at the same time.

Younger siblings escape all of that. 동생 works for either, and you add 남 or 여 only when the sex matters. So a family with one older and one younger brother gives a man 형 and 남동생, and a woman 오빠 and 남동생.

외 in 외할머니 means "outside" and marks the mother's side of the family. It reflects an older idea that a married woman joined her husband's household, making her parents the "outside" grandparents. The word survives even though the thinking behind it has largely gone.

아빠 and 엄마 are the affectionate forms, used by children and by adults speaking casually at home. 아버지와 어머니 are what you use in writing, when introducing your parents to someone, and in this chapter's exercises.

여러분의 가족은 몇 명이에요? 누가 있어요?

How many people are in your family? Who is there?

가 가족이 몇 명이에요?

How many people are in your family?

나 네 명이에요.

There are four.

가 언니가 있어요?

Do you have an older sister?

나 네, 한 명 있어요.

Yes, I have one.

명 is the counter for people from chapter 8, back again — 네 명, 한 명. Note that Korean counts the whole household including yourself, so 네 명 means four people in total, not four besides you.

동형-으시-

Verb/adjective + -으시- — the honorific infix

주어의 행위나 상태를 높여 말할 때 사용해요.

Used to raise the action or state of the subject.

가 할머니가 지금 뭐 하세요?
What is your grandmother doing now?

나 책을 읽으세요.
She is reading a book.

예문 — Examples

가 할아버지가 뭐 하세요?
What is your grandfather doing?

나 텔레비전을 보세요.
He is watching television.

아버지는 요리사세요. 어머니는 선생님이세요.

My father is a chef. My mother is a teacher.

-으시- — after a final consonant (받침)

읽다 → 읽으시다
reads — honorific

작다 → 작으시다
is small — honorific

★ **들다 → 들으시다**
listens — honorific, irregular

-시- — after a vowel

가다 → 가시다
goes — honorific

크다 → 크시다
is big — honorific

Here is the point that trips everyone up. You already know 하세요 from chapter 7, where it meant "please do it" — a command. It is the *same form*, and here it means "he or she does it", said respectfully. 할머니가 책을 읽으세요 is not telling grandmother to read; it is reporting that she is reading. Only context separates the two.

The 으 rule is the one you have met twice before: consonant at the end of the stem takes -으시-, vowel takes plain -시-. And 들다 is starred for the same reason as always — the ㄷ becomes ㄹ before a vowel, giving 들으시다.

-시- honours the *subject* of the sentence, not the listener. So you use it for your grandmother even when speaking to a close friend, and you never use it about yourself. 저는 가세요 is wrong in a way that sounds faintly absurd to a Korean ear.

Nouns take it through 이다: 선생님이시다 → 선생님이세요. After a vowel the 이 often drops in speech, which is why the example reads 요리사세요 rather than 요리사이세요. Both are correct; the short one is what you will hear.

연습 1 — 이분은 누구세요? 뭐 하세요?

가 정아라 선생님은 지금 뭐 하세요?
What is Ms Jeong Ara doing now?

나 선생님은 지금 한국어를 가르치세요.
She is teaching Korean now.

보기) 정아라 선생님, 한국어를 가르치다

Ms Jeong Ara, teach Korean → 가르치세요

2) 아버지, 요리하다

father, cook → 요리하세요

1) 어머니, 시장에 가다

mother, go to the market → 가세요

3) 할머니, 음악을 듣다

grandmother, listen to music → 들으세요

이분 is the honorific of 이 사람, "this person", built on 분 — the respectful counter for people that replaced 명 on the vocabulary list. 이분은 누구세요? is how you ask who someone is when that someone deserves respect.

연습 2 — 여러분 가족은 지금 뭐 하세요? 이야기해 보세요.

어휘와 문법 2

Vocabulary & grammar 2

높임말을 알아보세요.

Learn the honorific words.

높임말 — Honorific words that replace the plain one

이름 → 성함	name 성함이 어떻게 되세요? — may I ask your name?
나이 → 연세	age 연세가 어떻게 되세요? — how old are you?
생일 → 생신	birthday 할아버지 생신이에요
사람/명 → 분	person / counter for people 세 분 — three people, respectfully
있다 → 계시다	to be, to be present 할머니가 방에 계세요
먹다, 마시다 → 드시다, 잡수시다	to eat, to drink 선생님이 빵을 드세요
자다 → 주무시다	to sleep 할머니가 주무세요
죽다 → 돌아가시다	to die literally "to go back"
말하다 → 말씀하시다	to speak 선생님이 말씀하세요

These are different from page 115, and the difference matters. There you added 시 to an ordinary verb. Here the verb is *replaced* by a completely different word — you do not say 먹으시다 for an elder, you say 드시다. A handful of very common verbs work this way, and they have to be learned as separate vocabulary.

계시다 is the honorific of 있다 only in the sense of a person being somewhere. For possession — "my grandmother has a car" — you still use 있으시다, because it is the car that exists, not the grandmother. Beginners over-apply 계시다; keep it for people being present.

돌아가시다 literally means "to go back", and it is the only polite way to say someone died. 죽다 used of a person you respect is genuinely offensive. The euphemism is not optional decoration — it is the normal word.

연세가 어떻게 되세요? is worth memorising whole. Asking an older person 몇 살이에요? is rude; this is the phrase that replaces it. The same frame gives 성함이 어떻게 되세요? for a name — literally "how does your name come to be?", which is Korean's indirect way of asking.

Examples on the page

이분은 정아라 선생님이세요.

This is Ms Jeong Ara.

선생님이 빵을 드세요.

The teacher is eating bread.

정아라 선생님은 한국어를 가르치세요.

Ms Jeong Ara teaches Korean.

할머니가 방에 계세요.

Grandmother is in her room.

할머니가 주무세요.

Grandmother is sleeping.

Watch the shortening: 드시다 → 드세요, 주무시다 → 주무세요, 계시다 → 계세요. The 시 + 어요 collapses into 세요 every time, which is why all these honorific forms end the same way.

The birthday scene at the foot of the page**오늘은 할아버지 생신이에요.**

Today is grandfather's birthday.

할아버지 연세가 어떻게 되세요?

How old is your grandfather?

할아버지 성함이 어떻게 되세요?

What is your grandfather's name?

The picture shows a family round a table with 미역국 and side dishes while a woman carries in a cake for the grandfather in a party hat. Seaweed soup on a birthday is the tradition — it is what mothers eat after giving birth, so you eat it on the day you were born.

동형-지만

Verb/adjective + -지만 — "but"

앞의 내용과 반대되는 뒤의 내용을 연결해서 말할 때 사용해요.

Used to join a following statement that contrasts with the one before it.

가 한국어 공부가 어때요?

How is studying Korean?

나 한국어가 어렵지만 재미있어요.

Korean is difficult, but it's interesting.

예문 — Examples

가 라민 씨, 주말에도 수업이 있어요?

Ramin, do you have class at the weekend too?

나 아니요, 평일에는 수업이 있지만 주말에는 없어요.

No — I have class on weekdays, but not at the weekend.

오빠는 회사원이지만 저는 학생이에요.

My older brother is an office worker, but I'm a student.

-지만 — attaches straight to the stem

먹다 → 먹지만

eats, but

작다 → 작지만

is small, but

가다 → 가지만

goes, but

크다 → 크지만

is big, but

Tip

명사는 '명이지만, 명지만'을 사용해요.

Nouns take 이지만 after a consonant, 지만 after a vowel

-지만 has no 받침 rule at all: drop the 다 and add 지만, whatever the stem ends in. Like 하고 in chapter 8 and 도 in chapter 9, it asks nothing of you — a small mercy after the facing page.

Unlike English "but", 지만 sits at the end of the first clause rather than at the start of the second. 어렵지만 재미있어요 — "difficult-but, interesting". Korean puts its connectors on the back of the clause they belong to, which is worth getting used to now.

The tense goes before 지만, not after: 갔지만, "I went, but". You will need this in the reading passage, which has 동생은 안경을 썼지만 — my brother wore glasses, but.

There is also 그렇지만 from chapter 9, which means the same thing but starts a new sentence. 어렵지만 재미있어요 and 어려워요. 그렇지만 재미있어요 say the same; the first joins, the second separates.

연습 1 — 두 사람은 무엇이 달라요? 이야기해 보세요.

보기 안젤라는 머리가 길지만 언니는 머리가 짧아요.

Angela's hair is long, but her older sister's is short.

보기) 안젤라, 머리가 길다 | 언니, 머리가 짧다

Angela, long hair | older sister, short hair

2) 이링, 키가 작다 | 남동생, 키가 크다

Yiling is short | her younger brother is tall

1) 민호, 운동을 좋아하다 | 형, 운동을 안 좋아하다

Minho likes sport | his older brother doesn't

3) 아버지, 안경을 썼다 | 어머니, 안경을 안 썼다

Father wears glasses | mother doesn't

키가 크다 and 키가 작다 are how Korean says tall and short of a person: literally "the height is big / small". You cannot say 저는 커요 for "I am tall" — the height has to be the subject.

안경을 쓰다 is "to wear glasses", and Korean picks a different verb for each thing you put on: 쓰다 for glasses and hats, 입다 for clothes, 신다 for shoes, 끼다 for rings and gloves. English gets by with "wear" for all of them.

연습 2 — 여러분의 가족은 무엇이 달라요? 이야기해 보세요.

말하기와 듣기

Speaking & listening

이링 씨와 히에우 씨가 이야기하고 있어요. 다음과 같이 이야기해 보세요.

Yiling and Hieu are talking. Practise the conversation below.

이링 히에우 씨는 가족이 몇 명이에요?

Hieu, how many people are in your family?

히에우 다섯 명이에요. 할아버지, 아버지, 어머니, 누나가 있어요.

Five. There's my grandfather, my father, my mother and my older sister.

이링 할아버지는 연세가 많으세요?

Is your grandfather elderly?

히에우 네, 연세가 많으시지만 아주 건강하세요. 이링 씨는 가족이 어떻게 되세요?

Yes, he's getting on, but he's very healthy. And your family, Yiling?

이링 우리 가족은 부모님과 언니가 있어요.

In my family there are my parents and my older sister.

Swap in these sets

1) 다섯 명, 할아버지, 아버지, 어머니, 누나 | 할아버지 | 부모님, 언니

five; grandfather, father, mother, older sister | grandfather | parents, older sister

2) 네 명, 아버지, 어머니, 형 | 아버지 | 할머니, 아버지, 어머니, 동생

four; father, mother, older brother | father | grandmother, father, mother, younger sibling

연세가 많으시지만 puts the whole chapter into four syllables: the honorific noun 연세, the honorific infix 으시, and 지만 joining the contrast. Note the order — 많 + 으시 + 지만. The honorific always comes before the connector.

연세가 많으세요 is the polite way to say someone is old. Saying 늙으셨어요 would be blunt to the point of rudeness. Korean prefers "has many years" to "is old", and the difference is real.

부모님 is 부모 (parents) plus the honorific 님, and Koreans use the 님 form almost always — even about their own parents. The same 님 gives 선생님 and 사장님. Learn 부모님 as the default word.

우리 가족 means "my family", not "our family". Korean uses 우리 where English uses "my" for anything shared — 우리 집, 우리 나라, 우리 어머니. Saying 제 가족 is grammatical but sounds oddly detached.

연습 2 — 여러분의 가족을 소개해 보세요.

가 가족이 몇 명이에요?

How many people are in your family?

나 다섯 명이에요. 할아버지, 아버지, 어머니, 여동생이 있어요.

Five. There's my grandfather, my father, my mother and my younger sister.

듣기 — 제이슨 씨가 가족을 소개하고 있어요. 잘 듣고 답해 보세요.

1) 제이슨 씨 부모님은 어디에 계세요?

Where are Jason's parents?

2) 제이슨 씨 어머니는 지금 뭐 하세요?

What is Jason's mother doing now?

Both questions use honorifics about someone else's family — 계세요 for the parents, 하세요 for the mother. Answer in kind. Talking about a third person's relatives is exactly where Korean expects the honorific, and dropping it would sound careless.

읽기와 쓰기

Reading & writing

다음 글을 읽고 질문에 답해 보세요.

Read the passage and answer the questions.

우리 가족사진입니다.

This is a photo of my family.

할머니, 부모님과 남동생, 저입니다.

My grandmother, my parents, my younger brother and me.

아버지는 요리사입니다. 그래서 음식을 잘 만듭니다.

My father is a chef, so he cooks well.

어머니는 선생님이십니다. 남동생은 고등학생입니다.

My mother is a teacher. My younger brother is a high-school student.

동생은 안경을 썼지만 저는 안경을 안 썼습니다.

My brother wears glasses, but I don't.

할머니께서는 연세가 많으십니다.

My grandmother is elderly.

오늘은 할머니 생신입니다.

Today is my grandmother's birthday.

그래서 할머니가 많이 보고 싶습니다.

So I miss her very much.

Look at what carries 시 and what does not. 아버지는 요리사입니다 and 어머니는 선생님이십니다 both have it; 남동생은 고등학생입니다 does not, and neither does 저입니다. Parents and grandmother are raised, younger brother and self are not. The honorifics map the family hierarchy line by line.

할머니께서는 introduces 께서, the honorific version of the subject marker 이/가. It is a step up in formality from plain 할머니는 and belongs to written Korean. You are not expected to produce it yet — recognise it as "the subject, respectfully".

보고 싶다 is 보다 plus the -고 싶다 from chapter 7, and it means "to miss someone" as much as "to want to see". 할머니가 보고 싶습니다 is the ordinary way to say you miss your grandmother — literally "grandmother is want-to-see".

그래서 means "so, therefore" and starts a new sentence, unlike 지만 which joins one. The passage uses it twice, both times to give the consequence of what came before: he is a chef, so he cooks well.

Questions

1) 이 사람의 가족은 모두 몇 명이에요?

How many people are in this person's family? → 다섯 명이에요

2) 맞으면 ○, 틀리면 X 하세요.

Mark ○ if correct, X if wrong.

① 아버지는 요리를 잘합니다.

Father cooks well — ○

② 동생은 안경을 안 썼습니다.

The younger brother doesn't wear glasses — , he does; the writer doesn't

3) 이 사람은 오늘 왜 할머니가 보고 싶어요?

Why does this person miss their grandmother today? → 오늘이 할머니 생신이에요

Question 2② is the 지만 sentence turned into a trap. The passage says 동생은 안경을 썼지만 저는 안 썼습니다 — the brother does, the writer does not. Read which side of 지만 each person is on before you answer.

여러분의 가족을 소개해 보세요.

가족이 몇 명이에요?

How many people are in your family?

부모님은 어디에 계세요?

Where are your parents?

무엇을 좋아하세요?

What do they like?

Write it as the passage does: who is in the photo, what each person does, one contrast with 지만, and something you feel. Remember to put 시 on the parents and grandparents and leave it off yourself — that single habit is what this chapter is testing.

단어장 — New words

부모님

parents

고등학생

high-school student

문화와 정보 — 가족 호칭

Culture & information — What Koreans call their relatives

여러분은 가족을 어떻게 부릅니까?

What do you call your family members?

한국 사람들은 나보다 아랫사람은 이름을 부릅니다.

Koreans call those younger than themselves by name.

나보다 윗사람은 이름을 부르지 않습니다.

They do not call those older than themselves by name.

'할머니', '형'처럼 가족 호칭을 부릅니다.

They use the relationship word instead, like 할머니 or 형.

가족이 아니지만 가족처럼 친한 사람을 부를 때 '오빠', '형', '누나', '언니'라고 부르기도 합니다.

People who are not family but are as close as family are also called 오빠, 형, 누나 or 언니.

This is the practical consequence of the whole chapter. You will almost never hear a Korean address an older sibling by name. The name is replaced by the relationship — and since the relationship word depends on your own gender, two people in the same room may call the same man 형 and 오빠.

The extension to non-relatives is genuinely useful to know. A slightly older colleague or classmate can be 형 or 언니 once you are friendly, and being invited to use it is a sign the relationship has warmed. Using it too early, on the other hand, is presumptuous.

The photos show it in practice: a mother calling 수민아! to her daughter — the 아 ending attaches to a name that ends in a consonant and marks calling someone younger — while the grandchildren shout 할머니~ and 할아버지~, with no names at all.

아랫사람 and 윗사람 are literally "below-person" and "above-person". The vertical metaphor runs through the whole language, and it is the same 위/아래 you would use for the top and bottom of a shelf.

Questions

1) 한국에서는 아랫사람을 어떻게 불러요?

How do Koreans address someone younger? → 이름을 불러요

2) 한국에서는 윗사람을 어떻게 불러요?

How do Koreans address someone older? → 가족 호칭을 불러요

3) 여러분 고향에서는 가족을 어떻게 불러요?

How do people address family in your home country?

부르다 means both "to call someone by a name" and "to sing" — 노래를 부르다. Here it is the first sense throughout. Note also that this passage is written in 습니다 form, so the questions come back to you in 해요 form.

발음 · 배운 어휘 확인

Pronunciation · Vocabulary checklist

발음 1 — 다음을 듣고 따라 읽으세요.

들으세요	[드르세요] deu-reu-se-yo
어떻게	[어떠케] eo-tteo-ke
생신이에요	[생시니에요] saeng-si-ni-e-yo

들으세요 and 생신이에요 are plain linking, the 연음 you have met since chapter 5: a final consonant slides onto the vowel that follows. 들으 becomes [드르], 신이 becomes [시니]. Nothing changes except where the syllable break falls.

어떻게 → [어떠케] is different and worth learning properly. A ㅎ next to ㄱ, ㄷ, ㅈ or ㅂ merges with it into the aspirated ㅋ, ㅌ, ㅊ, ㅍ. Here 땡 + 게 gives [떠케]. The same rule produces 좋다 → [조타] and 축하 → [추카], so it will keep coming back.

발음 2 — 다음을 듣고 연습해 보세요.

가	할머니는 뭘 하세요? What is your grandmother doing?
나	음악을 들으세요. She's listening to music.
가	할아버지는 연세가 어떻게 되세요? How old is your grandfather?
나	일흔 둘이세요. He's seventy-two.
가	내일이 할머니 생신이에요. Tomorrow is my grandmother's birthday.

일흔 둘 uses the native numbers from chapter 6 — 일흔 is seventy, 둘 is two. Ages take native numbers, which is why the answer is 일흔 둘 and not 칠십이. And it ends in 이세요, the honorific 이다, because it is the grandfather's age.

배운 어휘 확인 — Vocabulary checklist

할머니 grandmother	할아버지 grandfather	외할머니 maternal grandmother
외할아버지 maternal grandfather	어머니(엄마) mother (mum)	아버지(아빠) father (dad)
언니 older sister — female speaker	오빠 older brother — female speaker	나 I, me
여동생 younger sister	남동생 younger brother	누나 older sister — male speaker

형

older brother — male speaker

연세

age — honorific

계시다

to be present — honorific

돌아가시다

to pass away — honorific

고등학생

high-school student

높임말

honorific language

생신

birthday — honorific

드시다/잡수시다

to eat, to drink — honorific

말씀하시다

to speak — honorific

성함

name — honorific

분

person — honorific counter

주무시다

to sleep — honorific

부모님

parents